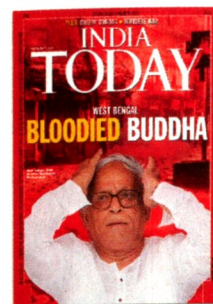
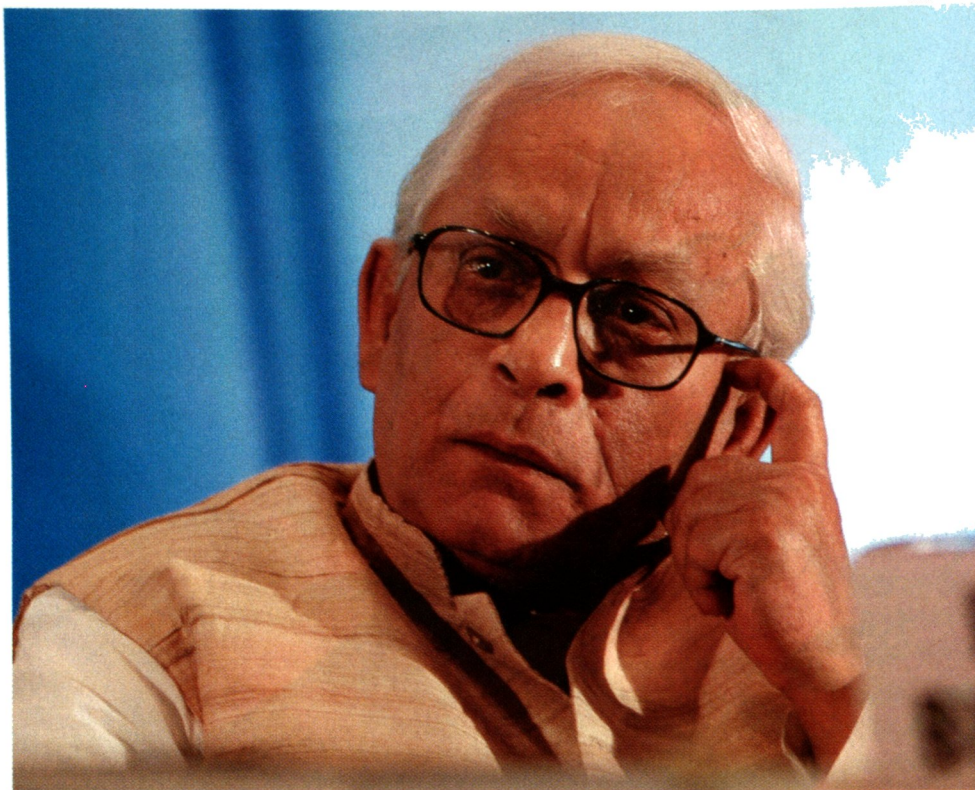


SUBIR HALDER



"Bloodied Buddha",
December 3, 2007

"Nandigram is a blot on our democracy. It is a reminder of the importance of a strong Opposition and the hazards of a long single-party rule."

SWASWATI SARKAR, *Kolkata*

Left Entangled

Public rage is blind. It is not guided by the red of communism, the saffron of the Right, or any other hue of democracy ("Buddha Under Siege", December 3). It just spreads like wild-fire fuelled by social and religious elements who do not have any ideology. The one unfortunate enough to be at the helm of affairs then—this time Buddhadeb Bhattacharya—becomes a sacrificial lamb.

K. CHIDANAND KUMAR,
Bangalore

Buddhadeb erred by underestimating Trinamool Congress chief Mamata Banerjee in the nascent stage of the Nandigram imbroglio. He dug his own grave by handling public protests tactlessly and insensitively.

Y.G. CHOUKSEY, *Pune*

Crowds are to politicians what water is to fish. Time

was when leaders guided and united crowds naturally. Next came a breed which was always surrounded by a coterie of sycophants that exploited communal sensitivities to "divide and drive" crowds. After Nandigram, Messers Buddhadeb and company have ushered in a "third degree" politics that would "flay and slay" innocent in an era of India Rising.

KARAN KHARB, *Noida*

The cover story exposes Buddhadeb, who is fast turning the crimson red of the Communists into a dangerous saffron. The genocide in Nandigram was a well-planned, cold-blooded operation just like Gujarat riots in 2002.

VITULL K. GUPTA, *Bhatinda*

It is said that power should never be taken for granted. This is where CPI(M) went wrong. They were overconfident about their power equations in West Bengal.

However, the Nandigram episode has turned everything on its head. Buddhadeb's progressive image has taken a beating and they have a stringent test ahead to prove their moral credentials.

BAL GOVIND, *Bareilly*

An honest man cannot survive in politics. Buddhadeb should take some lessons from Railway minister Lalu Prasad Yadav.

HARBANS SINGH, *on e-mail*

Saffron Battlefield

Gujarat Chief Minister Narendra Modi is right when he says pseudo-secularists would have screamed themselves hoarse if, even by mistake, a Rs 2 coin had carried an image of Lord Rama or Ganesha ("Back to Hindutva", December 3). Perhaps, that is why the headline does not go with the text of the story or the interview.

M.H. RAO, *Hyderabad*

Modi's interview was an eye-opener. The Nehruvian secularists, who are making concerted efforts in maligning him to appease the Muslims, must read it to understand that not only Gujarat, but the entire nation feels unsafe in the hands of UPA and needs a leader like Modi.

A.K. SHARMA, *Chandigarh*

The mere fact that Modi's popularity is on the rise and he can single-handedly trounce his opponents has prompted them to unleash desperate mudslinging on him. It only shows that Congress and its cronies have nothing to offer to counter Modi's progress card. That is why they have chosen to harp upon the past than the present.

N. DIVAKARAN, *on e-mail*

Doyen of Sly

Former prime minister H.D. Deve Gowda has put Shakuni of *Mahabharata* to shame ("The Ugly